Malte H. Hinrichs

Department of Economics, Queen's University Belfast
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Education

PhD in Economics 10/2023–present
Queen's University Belfast, UK
Affiliated with: Centre for Economics, Policy and History (CEPH)
Dissertation Title: *Water, Wheels, and the Wealth of Nations: Geography and Path Dependence in European Industrialization*
Viva: 21/10/2026 (Passed with no corrections; highest possible outcome)

MSc Economics 09/2020–09/2022
University of Mannheim, Germany
Thesis: *Engines of Growth? The Role of the Steam Engine for Long-Run Economic Development in Germany*

Visiting Student 02/2021–06/2021
NHH Norwegian School of Economics, Norway

BSc Economics 09/2017–08/2020
University of Mannheim, Germany
Thesis: *The Long-Term Effects of Colonialism on Income Inequality*

Visiting Student 08/2019–12/2019
Hong Kong University of Science and Technology, Hong Kong

Publications

"Water mills and human capital accumulation in industrialising Prussia" 07/2026
Explorations in Economic History, 101(1): 101767.
Article: doi:10.1016/j.eeh.2026.101767
Replication Package: doi:10.17632/pvnh7g4b39.2

Job Market Paper

"Leapfrogging or path dependence? Water mills and long-run growth in the Scottish Industrial Revolution"
Latest draft available on my website.

Abstract: Does technological change favour agile entrants or adaptable incumbents? I examine this using Scotland's industrialisation, testing whether steam power allowed new locations to "leapfrog" centres of water power. Using a newly constructed dataset linking over 1,200 pre-industrial mills to parish-level outcomes, and an instrumental variable strategy based on geographic endowments, I reject the leapfrogging hypothesis. An additional mill in 1755 caused 8% higher long-run population growth (driven by migration), with effects intensifying precisely when steam power became abundant. Micro-evidence reveals that hydraulically advantaged mill sites largely survived, transitioned to industrial production and avoided obsolescence by integrating steam power as a complementary technology. The findings demonstrate that proto-industrial water power provided the critical infrastructure and human capital for the steam age, challenging the view that coal endowments alone determined the industrial map.

Working Papers

"Market access without roads: First-nature geography and European city growth, 700–1800"
Draft available upon request.

Teaching Experience

Queen's University Belfast

Principles of Economics, Teaching Assistant (course design, tutorials)	09/2025–01/2026
Principles of Economics, Teaching Assistant (tutorials, exam supervision, marking)	09/2024–01/2025

University of Mannheim

Macroeconomics A, Teaching Assistant (tutorials, student mentoring)	02/2020–08/2020
Statistics II, Teaching Assistant (tutorials, student mentoring)	09/2019–12/2019
Principles of Economics, Teaching Assistant (tutorials, exam organisation)	09/2018–12/2018

Honours and Awards

Winner, Three Minute Thesis (3MT®) Competition, Queen's University Belfast 04/2026

New Researcher Prize, Economic History Society 04/2026

Graduated in top 20% of MSc Economics cohort, University of Mannheim 09/2022

Graduated in top 10% of BSc Economics cohort, University of Mannheim 08/2020

Dean's List, Hong Kong University of Science and Technology 12/2019

Research Grants and Funding

Santander Career Support Award 05/2026

Economic History Society New Researcher Conference Bursary 01/2026

EHES Conference Travel and Accommodation Grant 07/2025

Economic History Society Young Scholar Conference Bursary 01/2025

CEPH Studentship, Irish Higher Education Authority, full funding for PhD studies 10/2023

PROMOS Scholarship, German Academic Exchange Service, full funding for HKUST 06/2019

Professional Memberships

Economic History Society (UK)

European Historical Economics Society

Irish Economic Association

Academic Presentations

Invited Talks

Graduate Seminar in Economic and Social History, University of Oxford 05/2026

Economic History Seminar, University of Hohenheim 03/2026

Department of Economics Seminar Series, Heriot-Watt University Edinburgh 01/2026

Centre for Economic History Seminar Series, Queen's University Belfast 04/2024

Conference and Workshop Presentations

CEPH PhD Workshop, Queen's University Belfast 05/2026

Queen's Postgraduate Research Conference, Queen's University Belfast 05/2026

Economic History Society Conference, London School of Economics 04/2026

Irish Postgraduate and Early Career Economics Workshop, Maynooth University 01/2026

European Historical Economics Society Conference, University of Hohenheim 09/2025

CEPH Workshop in Quantitative Economic History, Queen's University Belfast 06/2025

Queen's Postgraduate Research Conference, Queen's University Belfast 06/2025

Economic History Society Conference, University of Strathclyde 04/2025

Centre for Economic History PhD Discussion Group, Queen's University Belfast 02/2025

Centre for Economic History PhD Discussion Group, Queen's University Belfast 03/2024

Professional Development

Graduate Teaching Assistant Workshop, The Economics Network 01/2025

Economic History Society Residential Training, University of Warwick 11/2024

Financial, Economic and Business History Summer School, University of Groningen 06/2024

Workshop for Teaching Assistants, University of Mannheim 09/2018

Public Engagement

'Die Kraft des Wassers: Deutschlands vergessene Industrialisierung' 08/2026
Featured Interview, GEO Magazine (Germany)

'Chatting GPT: What does history tell us about the future of AI?' 10/2025
Invited Speaker, ESRC Festival of Social Science

Industry Experience

KPMG AG Wirtschaftsprüfungsgesellschaft
Junior Consultant, Global Transfer Pricing (Mannheim, Germany) 04/2023–09/2023

Technical Skills

Econometric & Spatial Methods: Causal Inference (IV/2SLS, DiD, Panel/FE), Spatial Econometrics, GIS & Cost-Surface Analysis, Gravity Modelling

Software & Programming: R (`sf`, `terra`), Python, Stata, Matlab, QGIS, Git, Quarto, LaTeX

Languages: German (native), English (fluent), Spanish (intermediate), Latin (reading)

References

Chris Colvin (PhD Supervisor)
Queen's University Belfast
chris.colvin@qub.ac.uk · Website

Alexander Donges (MSc & BSc Advisor)
University of Mannheim
donges@uni-mannheim.de · Website

Alan Fernihough (PhD Supervisor)
Queen's University Belfast
a.fernihough@qub.ac.uk · Website

John Turner (CEPH Director)
Queen's University Belfast
j.turner@qub.ac.uk · Website

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